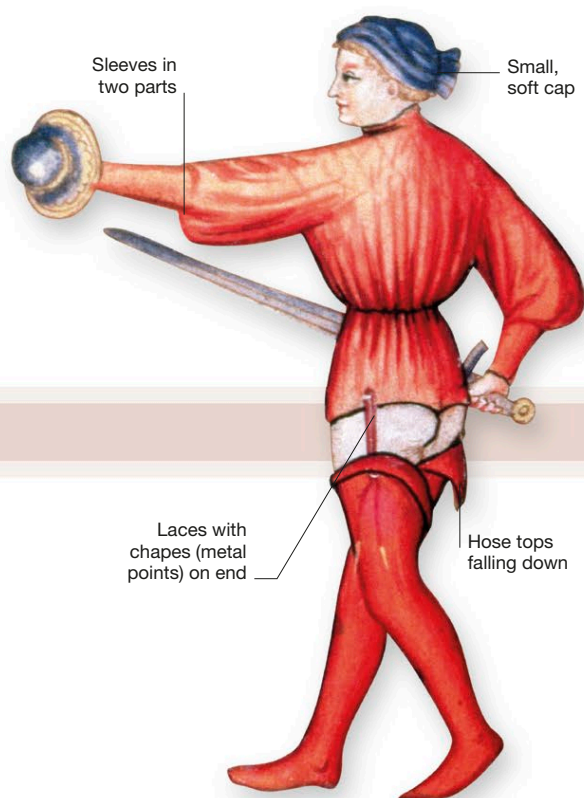
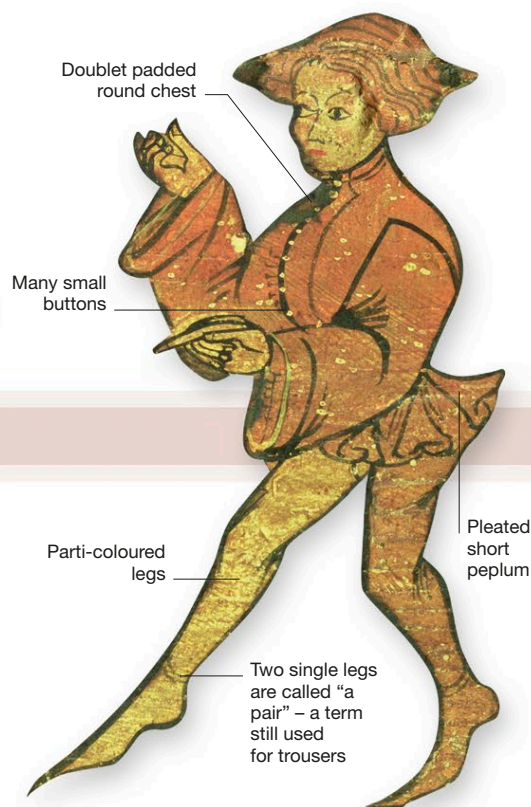




Hose laced to doublet Young men practising sword fighting would strip to their basic garments. Laces tie the individual legs of the thigh-high hose to the bottom of the doublet to hold them up. Linen drawers show underneath.



Spaniard in short doublet The dramatic shortening of men's top garments exposed the gaps in their hose. For modesty, hose were soon stitched together at the back, with a triangular piece of fabric over the crotch. Breeches were born.

FURS IN GREAT DEMAND



The Little Ice Age made temperatures in Europe dip in the 14th century. Demand for fur clothing was huge; sometimes up to 2,000 animals were used in one garment. Most luxury furs came from Russia: ermine, a stoat's winter coat; sable, a brown or black weasel fur; and brown marten skins. Cheaper local furs were budge (lambswool), coney (rabbit or hare), fox, and wolf.

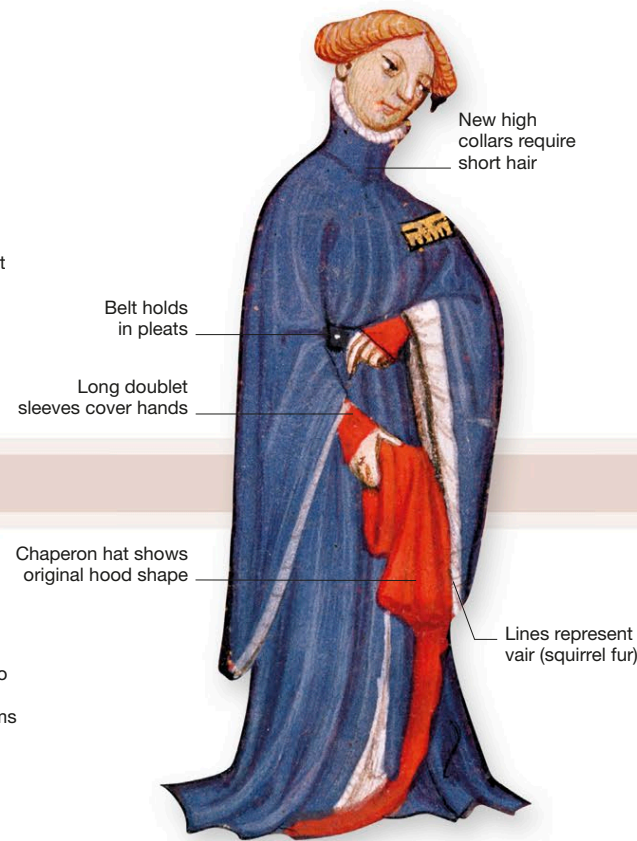
The 14th-century Italian merchants above inspecting vair (winter squirrel fur) have the same fur lining their hoods. Furs had heraldic meanings and painters too represented them with stylized patterns.



English style Shorter doublets with long sleeves were an English fashion. The cut of this reproduction exploits the silk's symmetrical formal pomegranate pattern. To economize, doublets could have plain bodies with silk used only for the sleeves.



Italian merchant in Flemish dress In van Eyck's 1434 portrait the sleeveless burgundy velvet *heuque* (cloak) is lined in marten fur. It has open sides, leaving the arms free. The ensemble is sombre, respectable, and of high quality.



Houppelande with vair lining Fashion took advantage of the wider and cheaper textiles produced on better looms. Large *houppelande* robes reached the ground at the hem and sometimes the sleeves, and replaced mantles.